

Dr. Jayakumar

Honorary Chairman | Marports Global Conference & Awards

Dr. Jayakumar: Pioneering Leader in India's Maritime Infrastructure Dr. Jayakumar's landmark achievement is spearheading the Vizhinjam International Seaport-the nation's first deep-water container transshipment hub near Thiruvananthapuram. As Founder CEO and Managing Director of Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited, he drove its conceptualization, planning, design, structuring, and execution, culminating in its commissioning in 2024. This strategic asset harnesses its strategic location and natural 20+ meter depths to cut India's reliance on foreign transshipment hubs, boosting maritime trade and economic growth. His journey with Vizhinjam began in 2001 as Special Private Secretary to Kerala's Minister for Ports, building on prior expertise as Technical Adviser of Westport Malaysia in the development of transshipment and bulk terminals; and part of Malaysian port delegations to India, Myanmar, and Cambodia. A top-ranking Civil Engineering graduate from College of Engineering Thiruvananthapuram, Dr Jayakumar earned an MTech and PhD in Ocean Engineering from IIT Madras. Early in his career (1988-1994), as project head of IIT Madras's Wave Energy Group, he led the design, construction, and installation of India's pilot wave power plant off Vizhinjam-sponsored by the Government of India-to harness electricity from ocean waves. He served as the CEO of Pondicherry Port and Special Economic Zone during 2007 to 2016 and also held positions of Managing Director of Kerala State Maritime Development Cooperative Limited and Member of the Kerala Maritime Board. Dr. Jayakumar was selected and trained by the U.S. Department of Commerce's Special American Business Internship Program in Port Development for Asian experts, held in Washington, DC. A prolific author of technical papers and committee member at state/national levels, he has earned awards like 'Outstanding Engineering Personality' from the Institution of Engineers (India) - Kerala, and a 2024 Dual Doctorate from the European International University (Paris) and AIMRI (UAE) for his maritime contributions. Today, Dr. Jayakumar serves as the Principal Advisor at ULCCS, the world's largest cooperative, on infrastructure projects.